

ANGEL ACTION · BONES & JOINTS

Sprains and Strains — RICE

Use the RICE method for sprains and strains — Rest, Ice (20 minutes every 2 hours), Compression bandage, and Elevation above heart level. Seek medical aid if pain, swelling or loss of function persist.

What is a sprain vs strain?

- **Sprain:** stretched or torn **ligament** (joint).
- **Strain:** stretched or torn **muscle or tendon**.

If you are unsure whether it is a sprain or a **fracture**, treat as a fracture and seek medical assessment.

RICE

- **R — Rest** the injured area for at least 24 hours.
- **I — Ice** pack (wrapped in a cloth) for 20 minutes every 2 hours for the first 24–48 hours.
- **C — Compression** with a firm elastic bandage covering the joint above and below.
- **E — Elevation** of the limb above the level of the heart whenever possible.

Do NOT (HARM)

- **H — Heat** (no hot showers, heat packs)
- **A — Alcohol**
- **R — Running** or strenuous activity
- **M — Massage**

...for at least the first 48 hours.

*Adapted from **Australian First Aid 5th Edition**. Get the full guide and live CPR metronome at firstaidangel.org.*